CAPSTONE 03 · AUTOMATION SUITE · SOLUTION BRIEF

How to automate a slice of your week, step by step.

Ten steps. You build the three pieces in the order they depend on each other: the clean files first, then the format, then the schedule that uses both.

TOTAL TIME	STEPS	WORKED EXAMPLE	NEEDS
About five hours, plus three cycles	Ten, in order	Meera's morning campaign pulse	Paid plan and the Claude desktop app

THE SYSTEM YOU ARE BUILDING

4.6 · RUN ONCE

Cowork task

Turns weeks of messy exports into one clean master file in a fixed format.

2.6 · WRITTEN ONCE

Skill

Defines the brief: its sections, length, voice and what to flag.

5.2 · RUNS ON A CADENCE

Scheduled brief

Each run adds new files to the master, then writes the brief with the Skill.

↓ every cycle ↓

A dated brief in your folder, every working morning

You read it in two minutes. Three cycles of it, plus what you fixed after the first, make your submission.

THE WEEK

DAY 1

Prepare

Pick the slice, set up the folder, run the Cowork task.

`Steps 01-03 · 1.5 h`

DAY 2

Shape and schedule

Build the Skill, write and test the prompt, schedule it.

`Steps 04-07 · 2 h`

DAY 3

Cycle 1

Read it, log it, fix what broke.

`Steps 08-09 · 45 min`

DAY 4

Cycle 2

Read it, log it.

`Step 08 · 10 min`

DAY 5

Cycle 3 + write-up

Log the last cycle, write it up.

`Steps 08, 10 · 1.5 h`

BEFORE YOU START

- [ ] A Pro, Max, Team or Enterprise plan. On Team and Enterprise, an admin must have Cowork turned on.
- [ ] The Claude desktop app, on macOS or Windows, for access to your local files.
- [ ] A recurring job whose inputs arrive as files.
- [ ] Your Skill from Capstone 01, if you built one. You will build a second.

WORKED EXAMPLE · MEERA

Every morning Meera downloads ad and sales exports, pastes them into a sheet and works out what changed overnight. It takes 25 minutes and she skips it on busy days. She automates it into a five-line "campaign pulse" waiting in her folder by 8:30.

Menus move between releases. If a label differs, look under Customize or Settings.

01

15 MINUTES · DAY 1

Pick the slice of your week to automate.

Good candidates pass four tests. It recurs at least weekly. Its inputs arrive as files or in a connected tool. Its output has the same shape every time. And you can check an output in two minutes.

WORKED EXAMPLE · MEERA MAPS HER SLICE ONTO THE THREE PIECES

PART	WHAT IT IS FOR MEERA	WHICH PIECE
Inputs	Daily CSV exports from Meta Ads, Google Ads and Shopify, named inconsistently	—
Preparation	Eight weeks of past exports merged into one master sheet with standard columns	Cowork task
Shape	A five-line pulse: spend, revenue, return on ad spend, the top mover, one action	Skill
Cadence	Every weekday at 8:30, before her stand-up	Scheduled brief
Reader	Meera, then her team of three	—

× AVOID A job that needs judgement calls you cannot write down. Automate the routine part and keep the judgement.

✓ CHECK You can fill in all five rows of the table for your own slice.

02

15 MINUTES · DAY 1 · MODULE 4.6

Set up a dedicated folder and open Cowork.

01 Create one folder for this automation, with four subfolders: `inbox` for raw files, `clean` for the master file, `briefs` for outputs and `archive` for processed files.

02 Copy your real input files into `inbox`.

03 Open the Claude desktop app and choose **Cowork** in the message box. Older builds show it as a tab at the top.

04 Attach the folder, and grant access to that folder only.

`Claude desktop app` → `Cowork` → `Attach a folder` → `Lumen-automation` → `Allow`

× AVOID Granting your Documents, Desktop or home folder. Cowork can create, move and edit files in any folder you grant.

✓ CHECK Ask Cowork "List the folders and files you can see." It lists your four subfolders and your input files, nothing more.

03

45 MINUTES · DAY 1 · MODULE 4.6

Run the Cowork task end to end on real files.

Cowork reads your request, makes a plan and carries it out on the files. Write the prompt like a handover note to a careful assistant: the goal, the inputs, the output, the rules, and a request to show you the plan first.

TEMPLATE · COWORK TASK PROMPT

Goal: [what the finished result is for].
Inputs: [which files, in which subfolder, and what is odd about them].
Output: [file name, format, columns or sections, and where to save it].
Rules: do not delete anything. Leave the original files untouched. If something is unclear, note it in a change log rather than guessing.
Before you start, show me your plan. When you finish, write [change-log.md] listing what you did and anything you could not handle.

WORKED EXAMPLE · MEERA'S COWORK PROMPT

"Goal: one clean master file of our ad and sales performance, so a daily brief can read it. Inputs: the 120 CSV files in inbox, exported from Meta Ads, Google Ads and Shopify over eight weeks. Names and column headers differ by source. Output: clean/performance-master.xlsx with one row per channel per day, and the columns date, channel, campaign, spend, orders, revenue and return on ad spend. Rules: do not delete anything, leave the originals untouched, and log any file you could not read. Show me your plan first. When you finish, write clean/change-log.md."

01 Read the plan Claude proposes before you approve it. Correct it in plain words if a step is wrong: "Treat refunds as negative revenue, not as orders."

02 Let it run. Cowork works through the steps, and asks before sensitive actions such as deleting files.

03 Open the output. Pick two days at random and check their figures against the original export files by hand.

04 Read the change log. Fix any file it could not handle, then ask Cowork to rerun just that part.

× AVOID Approving a plan you have not read. The plan is where you catch a wrong assumption cheaply.

✓ CHECK The master file exists, two spot-checked days match the source exports exactly, and the change log explains anything left out.

04

45 MINUTES · DAY 2 · MODULE 2.6

Build the Skill the brief leans on.

An unattended brief drifts unless its format is written down. The Skill fixes what every cycle looks like, so cycle three reads like cycle one. Build it the way you did in Capstone 01: with the skill-creator in a chat, or by writing the file and uploading the ZIP.

Customize → Skills → + → Upload a skill

WORKED EXAMPLE · MEERA'S SKILL.MD

```
---
name: campaign-pulse
description: Writes Lumen's five-line morning campaign pulse from
  clean/performance-master.xlsx. Use for the daily pulse, morning pulse or
  campaign brief.
---

# Campaign pulse

## Steps
1. Use the most recent complete day in the master file. Compare it with the
   average of the seven days before it.
2. Report spend, revenue and return on ad spend, each with the change against
   the seven-day average.
3. Name the single campaign that moved revenue most, up or down.
4. Flag one anomaly: spend with no orders, a campaign that stopped, or a figure
   more than double its average. If there is none, say "No anomalies."
5. Suggest one action, phrased as a question for Meera to decide.

## Format
Five lines, in this order: Headline · Numbers · Top mover · Anomaly · Action.
First line: "Pulse for [date]: [the one thing to know]".
Last line: "Data to [date], [n] new files read."

## Voice
Plain. Figures in rupees with no decimals. No adjectives about performance.
```

01 Upload it, then test it in a Cowork task with the folder attached: *"Write today's campaign pulse."*

02 Check the figures against the master file. Fix the steps, not the output, then re-upload.

✓ CHECK Two test runs on different days produce the same five-line shape, with figures that match the master file.

05

30 MINUTES · DAY 2 · MODULE 5.2

Write a self-contained prompt.

A scheduled task starts fresh every time. It cannot see this chat, cannot ask you a question at 8:30, and cannot know what "the usual file" means. Apply the stranger test: if someone who has never met you pasted this prompt into a new task, would they produce the right brief?

INGREDIENT	WHAT TO WRITE
Purpose	What the brief is for, and who reads it
Where things are	Exact folder and file names, never "my files"
Steps	Numbered, in order, including housekeeping such as moving processed files
The Skill	Named explicitly: "Use the campaign-pulse skill"
Dates	Relative and unambiguous: "the most recent complete day", not "yesterday"
Output	File name pattern, format and where to save it
When things go wrong	A default for every gap. Never stop to ask; note the problem in the output

WORKED EXAMPLE · MEERA'S SCHEDULED PROMPT, IN FULL

You are preparing Lumen's morning campaign pulse for Meera, the marketing manager, who reads it before her 9:00 stand-up.

1. In the folder Lumen-automation, look in inbox for CSV exports from Meta Ads, Google Ads and Shopify that are not yet in clean/performance-master.xlsx.
2. Add their rows to the master file in its existing columns: date, channel, campaign, spend, orders, revenue, return on ad spend. Do not change existing rows.
3. Move each processed file into archive. Never delete files.
4. Use the campaign-pulse skill to write the pulse for the most recent complete day in the master file.
5. Save it as briefs/pulse-YYYY-MM-DD.md, using that day's date.

If inbox is empty, write the pulse from the master file and say "No new files" on the last line. If a file cannot be read, leave it in inbox and name it in the pulse. Do not ask questions; record anything uncertain in the pulse.

× AVOID "Do the usual pulse." The task has no memory of what usual means.

✓ CHECK Your prompt covers all seven ingredients, and gives a default for empty or broken inputs.

06

15 MINUTES · DAY 2

Test the prompt by hand, once.

01 Drop one new export into `inbox`.

02 Start a brand-new Cowork task with the folder attached, paste the prompt exactly as written, and run it.

03 Check the four things the schedule must get right: the new rows are in the master, the file moved to archive, the pulse uses the Skill's five-line shape, and it saved under the right name.

04 If anything is off, fix the prompt, not the output, and run it once more in another new task.

✓ CHECK A fresh task, given only the prompt, produces a correct pulse without asking you anything.

07

10 MINUTES · DAY 2 · MODULE 5.2

Schedule it.

● ROUTE A · FROM YOUR TEST TASK

Use /schedule

01 In the Cowork task where your test ran, type `/schedule`.

02 Answer Claude's questions about the cadence.

03 Review the name, schedule and instructions it proposes. Replace the instructions with your tested prompt if they differ.

04 Click **Schedule**.

ROUTE B · BY HAND

Set it up manually

`Scheduled` → `New task` → `Set up manually`

01 Name the task and paste your prompt.

02 Choose an approval mode, a frequency and, optionally, a model.

03 Choose your automation folder so the task can reach it.

04 Save.

01 **Pick a cadence that gives you three cycles inside the capstone week.** Frequencies include hourly, daily, weekly and weekdays. Meera chose weekdays at 8:30. A weekly brief can run daily during the capstone and move to weekly afterwards.

02 **Keep your computer ready at run time.** A task that uses local files reaches them through the desktop app, so the app must be open and the computer awake when it runs.

✓ CHECK The task appears on the Scheduled tasks page with the right time, folder and prompt. Run it once on demand to confirm it works outside your test.

08

10 MINUTES PER CYCLE · DAYS 3 TO 5

Run three cycles, and log each one.

01 Each morning, open the new brief before you do anything else with it. Do not edit the file; your submission shows each cycle as it arrived.

02 Check two figures against the master file or the source export.

03 Fill in one row of the cycle log. "Useful" means you acted on it, or would have.

WORKED EXAMPLE · MEERA'S CYCLE LOG

CYCLE	RAN	ON TIME	FIGURES RIGHT	USEFUL, 1–5	WHAT WENT WRONG
1 · Wed	8:31	Yes	1 of 2	2	Counted Shopify refunds as orders; action was vague
2 · Thu	8:30	Yes	2 of 2	4	Anomaly line flagged a paused campaign as "stopped"
3 · Fri	8:30	Yes	2 of 2	5	None. She paused one ad set on its suggestion

✓ CHECK Three unedited outputs saved, and three complete rows in your cycle log.

09

30 MINUTES · AFTER CYCLE 1

Refine after the first run.

Fix each problem in the piece where it started. Then run the task on demand to test the fix before the next cycle.

SYMPTOM	USUAL CAUSE	FIX IT IN
Wrong figure	A data rule nobody wrote down	The master file's rules, via a short Cowork task, and the prompt
Wrong shape or vague lines	Loose Skill steps	The Skill: tighten the step, re-upload
Wrong file, missing step, a stall	A gap in the prompt	The scheduled task's prompt
Did not run	App closed or computer asleep	Your setup, not the prompt

WORKED EXAMPLE · MEERA'S TWO FIXES AFTER CYCLE 1

Refunds: she added "Shopify rows with a negative amount are refunds: subtract them from revenue and do not count them as orders" to step 2 of the prompt. Vague action: she changed Skill step 5 to "Suggest one action on a named campaign, with the figure that justifies it."

✓ CHECK Every problem from cycle 1 has a fix, made in the right piece, and an on-demand run confirms it.

10

60 MINUTES · DAY 5

Write it up, then submit.

Two to three pages, plus the three cycle outputs attached. Someone reading it should understand how the pieces connect without opening your folder.

SECTION	WHAT GOES IN IT	LENGTH
1 · The slice	What you automated, how long it took by hand, and who reads the output	1 para
2 · The three pieces	The Cowork task, the Skill and the scheduled brief: what each does, in two sentences each	½ page
3 · How they connect	A simple diagram: inputs → Cowork → master file → schedule + Skill → brief	diagram
4 · The prompt	The scheduled prompt, in full, as it runs now	box
5 · Three cycles	Your cycle log, with the three outputs attached unedited	table
6 · What I refined	The fixes after cycle 1, where you made each, and what changed	½ page

To draw the diagram, ask Claude in a chat: *"Draw a simple left-to-right diagram of these steps as an Artifact: [paste section 2]."*

BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

- [ ] Cowork task run on real files, output spot-checked
- [ ] Skill named in the scheduled prompt
- [ ] Prompt passes the stranger test
- [ ] Three cycles, outputs attached unedited
- [ ] Refinement after cycle 1, explained
- [ ] Confidential figures and names removed

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

No Cowork option	Needs a paid plan and the desktop app. On Team or Enterprise, ask your admin.
Task did not run	Keep the app open and the computer awake at run time.
It cannot find your files	Choose the folder in the scheduled task's settings.
It stalls on a question	Add a default for that case to the prompt.
The format drifts	Name the Skill in the prompt and tighten its steps.